

Interview Feedback

Brew & Bean Profitability · 2026-07-04 · Overall: strong

Top improvement

Sharpen the commercial recommendation to match the model's primary levers — instead of treating pricing as exhausted, propose selective 8–12% increases on less-elastic specialty SKUs plus multi-year supply/hedging contracts, and add a non-obvious option like a low-cost commodity blend for budget locations.

Rubric Scores

Problem Structuring

strong

What went well

Restated the objective and opened with sharp, decision-relevant clarifying questions before structuring.

| *"is that 15% coming from opening new stores, or from existing stores selling more?"*

| *"is 6% margin unusually low for our competitors too, or is this specific to Brew & Bean?"*

Self-diagnosed the MECE flaw in the first framework and rebuilt into a clean two-branch revenue-vs-cost tree with cross-cutting overlay.

| *"my 'growth' bucket isn't cleanly separate from the other two"*

| *"A cleaner structure would be two mutually exclusive branches: revenue side (price per unit, product mix) and cost side (COGS, then operating costs, split into fixed and variable)"*

Prioritized where the answer likely lives and tied the structure to the decision.

| *"I'd size those two first"*

| *"one query, and it either points me somewhere or rules out half the tree"*

What needs work

First framework prematurely declared the case a pure cost problem, closing off the revenue branch until challenged.

| *"the margin drop has to be a cost problem — costs are rising faster than revenue"*

Missed opportunities

At turn 3, the candidate asserted 'the margin drop has to be a cost problem' before considering price/mix.

| A great answer: "Margin can fall two ways — we're either earning less per unit or spending more per unit — so before I assume it's costs I'd split it into a revenue branch (price, mix) and a cost branch, then test which moved."

Quantitative & Analytical Rigor

strong

What went well

Reframed the 18-point drop in both absolute and relative terms with a clear business implication.

| *"that's an 18-point drop, but in relative terms it's a 75% collapse in margin"*

| *"we lost three-quarters of our margin" lands harder"*

Derived unit volume growth cleanly from price and revenue figures.

| *"Prices are up 10% and revenue is up 15%, which means unit volume grew only modestly — roughly 5%"*

Sized the bean contribution against total COGS with a stated-assumption sanity check rather than accepting beans as the full answer.

| *"a 40% rise on a 10–15% slice moves total COGS by maybe 4–6 points, not 16"*

| *"I'm working from industry rule-of-thumb here, not your data, so flag that as a moderate-confidence estimate"*

What needs work

The 'cost per cup went up ~50%' napkin estimate was asserted loosely without showing the derivation cleanly.

| *"cost per cup went up somewhere on the order of 50%. That's not normal inflation"*

Missed opportunities

At turn 15, claiming per-cup cost rose ~50% without laying out the arithmetic.

| A great answer: "If price rose 10% and COGS went from 42% to 58% of that higher price, cost per cup went from $0.42 \times 6.20 = \$2.60$ to $0.58 \times 6.80 = \$3.94$ — about a 51% jump, far beyond normal inflation."

Data & Exhibit Interpretation

strong

What went well

Interpreted each data point with an immediate implication and next step, eliminating branches cleanly.

| *"that clears the revenue branch. Price per cup rose 10%, so we're earning more per unit, not less"*

| *"COGS alone explains almost the entire collapse. Everything else — rent, labor — is basically a rounding error"*

Read the cost-structure table systematically, isolating COGS as the sole driver and dismissing labor/overhead exactly as the key intends.

| *"COGS: 42 '50 '58, climbing 8 points a year, 16 total. Labor: flat at 22 the whole time"*

| *"16 of the 18 points come from COGS; overhead is a distant, marginal contributor; labor is a non-factor"*

Extracted a non-obvious pattern from the trend shape (linear vs one-off) to sharpen the hypothesis.

| *"the trend is linear and steady — 8 points per year"*

| *"A single bad bean contract or a one-off price spike would more likely show up as a jump than a plateau"*

Business Judgment & Insight

strong

What went well

Resisted the tempting single-cause answer and reasoned about controllable levers.

| *"I'd resist walking into the CEO's office and saying 'it's coffee prices' — that's the easy answer, it's incomplete, and it points at something we can't control"*

| *"we already passed a 10% price increase to customers and it wasn't enough, which limits how much more we can lean on pricing"*

Consistently distinguished confirmed findings from hypotheses and flagged confidence levels.

| *"high confidence it's a COGS problem; moderate confidence beans are only a partial driver; still unverified what makes up the rest"*

What needs work

Missed the model answer's pricing insight — that specialty SKUs have less-elastic demand where selective increases could work — instead treating pricing as largely exhausted.

| *"Not across-the-board hikes, since we've tested customer tolerance already"*

Missed opportunities

In the recommendation, pricing was downplayed rather than segmented by elasticity.

| A great answer: "The 10% increase was blanket; I'd instead test selective 8–12% increases on high-margin specialty drinks where demand is less elastic, while protecting price on budget SKUs."

Creativity & Brainstorming

adequate

What went well

Generated a structured list of candidate COGS drivers beyond the obvious bean-price story.

| *"Waste and spoilage — especially if new stores are over-ordering"*

| *"Mix shift toward milk- and food-heavy drinks, which carry more COGS per dollar"*

What needs work

No dedicated brainstorm stage occurred, and the idea-generation stayed within cost-diagnosis rather than reaching for non-obvious commercial solutions like a low-cost commodity blend for budget locations.

| *"Something else moved too"*

| *"loss of a volume discount from procurement"*

Missed opportunities

At the recommendation stage, solution ideas were confined to procurement/waste/pricing.

| A great answer: "We could also pilot a lower-cost 'commodity blend' in budget-conscious locations to protect margin without touching the premium line, and explore product reformulation on the highest-COGS drinks."

Synthesis & Recommendation

strong

What went well

Led answer-first with a clear, prioritized recommendation tied to the analysis.

| *"this is a cost problem, specifically input costs, and it's fixable — but not primarily through more price increases"*

| *"I'd frame three moves, in order of leverage"*

Named the key data gap and turned it into an actionable parallel next step rather than stalling.

| *"start the procurement renegotiation now because it's high-leverage regardless of the mix, and in parallel pull the COGS breakdown"*

Surfaced a clear risk/caveat and stayed disciplined about confidence.

| *"I can size the problem — 16 of 18 points is COGS — but I can't yet tell you how much of it is beans versus milk versus waste"*

What needs work

Recommendation omitted the elasticity-based selective pricing move and multi-year supply contracts as a lock-in mechanism, which were the model's primary levers.

| *"More like nudging the menu toward higher-margin items and trimming the drinks that are COGS-heavy"*

Missed opportunities

Closing recommendation could have quantified the target — how much margin recovery each lever buys.

| A great answer: "If procurement and hedging claw back even half the 16-point COGS swing, we recover ~8 points of margin toward the low-teens; selective specialty pricing could add another few points."

Communication & Delivery

strong

What went well

Consistently top-down and signposted with hypothesis language.

| *"Two reasons. First... Second..."*

| *"My working hypothesis — and I'd want data to confirm"*

Narrated structure before detail and handed control back to the interviewer cleanly.

| *"Where do you want to point me?"*

| *"Let me read it back"*

What needs work

Turn 11 contains a large verbatim block re-pasting earlier answers, showing bloat/repetition that would read as rambling in a live setting.

| *"Fair enough. Here's how I'd structure the investigation. Since margin is profit over revenue, and revenue is actually growing, the margin drop has to be a cost problem"*

Pushback, Composure & Case Leadership

strong

What went well

Responded to the MECE challenge with specific self-correction rather than defensiveness or reflexive capitulation.

| *"Honest answer: it's not fully MECE. The overlap problem: my 'growth' bucket isn't cleanly separate from the other two"*

Proactively challenged its own bean-price instinct when handed the 40% figure — the exact trap the case sets.

| *"let me push back on my own instinct here, because I think the beans are a trap if I stop there"*

| *"beans alone don't get us to a 16-point swing"*

What needs work

Held position well but leaned on unconfirmed industry rules of thumb; could have asked the interviewer to confirm the bean share rather than estimating.

| *"they're typically a fairly small slice of a coffee shop's COGS — often something like 10–15%"*

Model Answer

Structure

Strong structure disaggregates profit = revenue – costs, then breaks revenue into volume × price and costs into COGS / labor / overhead / other. The candidate should hypothesize which bucket is the driver before asking for data. Bonus: asks about competitive context (are peers also seeing this?) and pricing power.

Recommendation

Primary recommendation: selectively raise prices by 8–12% on high-margin SKUs (specialty drinks) where demand is less elastic, while negotiating multi-year bean supply contracts to lock in cost. Secondary: pilot a lower-cost 'commodity blend' for budget-conscious locations. Do not recommend blanket cost cuts — labor and overhead are already lean.

Full Transcript

Interviewer · 0:02

I'm your interviewer. Let's walk through this case together.

Your client is Brew & Bean, a specialty coffee chain with 200 locations. Profit margin dropped from 24% to 6% over two years despite 15% revenue growth. The CEO wants to know why and how to fix it. Does that land clearly, or do you have clarifying questions before we start?

Candidate · 0:16

That lands clearly. Before I dig in, three quick clarifying questions: First, on the revenue growth — is that 15% coming from opening new stores, or from existing stores selling more? That changes the story a lot. Second, is this margin drop happening across all 200 locations, or is it concentrated in certain stores or regions? And third, is 6% margin unusually low for our competitors too, or is this specific to Brew & Bean? In other words, is the whole industry getting squeezed or is this our problem?

Interviewer · 0:18

Good questions. On all three — we don't have that level of detail yet. You'd have to build those into your investigation plan. What's your opening framework for tackling this?

Candidate · 0:37

Fair enough. Here's how I'd structure the investigation. Since margin is profit over revenue, and revenue is actually growing, the margin drop has to be a cost problem — costs are rising faster than revenue. So I'd frame the whole case around isolating where those costs are coming from. I'd break it into three buckets. First, cost of goods sold — that's coffee beans, milk, cups, food. Have input prices spiked? Coffee bean prices have been volatile, so that's a real candidate. Second, operating costs — labor, rent, utilities. Wages have risen a lot recently, and if we're opening new stores, we may be carrying rent and staffing on locations that aren't profitable yet. Third, the growth itself. That 15% revenue growth isn't free. If we grew by opening new stores or discounting heavily to drive traffic, we could be buying revenue at a loss. New stores especially can drag margins for the first year or two while they ramp up. So my plan would be to size each of these buckets — figure out which one moved the most over the two years — and focus there. My instinct is the growth strategy and labor are the biggest suspects, but I'd want the numbers to confirm before committing. Where would you like me to start?

Interviewer · 0:38

Is that framework MECE? What's not in it?

Candidate · 0:59

Honest answer: it's not fully MECE. The overlap problem: my "growth" bucket isn't cleanly separate from the other two. If new stores drag margin, that shows up as labor and rent in bucket two — so I'd be double-counting the same costs under two headings. Growth is really a lens on the other buckets, not a parallel category. The gap: I framed this as purely a cost problem, but that's not airtight. Margin can also fall if revenue quality drops — for example, if that 15% growth came from discounting, the price per cup fell, so revenue grew on volume while margin per unit shrank. That's a pricing/revenue-mix issue, not a cost line. I glossed over it. A cleaner structure would be two mutually exclusive branches: revenue side (price per unit, product mix) and cost side (COGS, then operating costs, split into fixed and variable). Then treat new-store ramp as a cross-cutting factor I test against whichever line moved — not its own bucket. So — better MECE version: are we earning less per unit, or spending more per unit? Then decompose each.

Interviewer · 1:00

Okay. Go ahead.

Candidate · 1:20

Good — let me revise it cleanly. The math anchor: margin fell means cost per dollar of revenue rose. So either we're earning less per unit sold, or spending more per unit. Two mutually exclusive branches. Revenue side — are we earning less per unit? I'd check whether average price per cup fell. That happens if we discounted to drive traffic, or if the product mix shifted toward cheaper items. This matters because 15% revenue growth on falling prices means we grew on pure volume, which quietly crushes margin. Cost side — are we spending more per unit? Two sub-branches: Variable costs (COGS): beans, milk, cups, food — do they scale with each cup sold. Coffee bean prices have been genuinely volatile the last couple years, so this is a live suspect. Fixed costs: rent, salaried labor, utilities — costs we pay regardless of volume. Then the cross-cutting test: new-store ramp. Rather than its own bucket, I'd overlay it on whichever line moved. If fixed costs jumped, I'd ask whether it's new stores carrying rent and staff before they've ramped. If price per unit dropped, I'd ask whether new stores are discounting to build a customer base. My working hypothesis — and I'd want data to confirm — is that the drop is too steep and too fast to be input costs alone. An 18-point margin swing in two years smells like either aggressive discounting or a wave of unprofitable new stores. I'd size those two first. Where do you want to point me?

Interviewer · 1:24

Walk me through that 18-point swing — how did you get there?

Candidate · 1:44

It's just the two numbers you gave me: margin went from 24% to 6%. 24 minus 6 is 18 percentage points. One thing to flag, since precision matters here: that's an 18-point drop, but in relative terms it's a 75% collapse in margin — we kept only a quarter of the profitability we had. I'd use the relative framing when I talk to the CEO, because "we lost three-quarters of our margin" lands harder and is arguably the truer picture of the damage. And to be clear about what I don't know yet — that 18 points tells me the size of the problem, not the cause. It doesn't tell me whether it's price, COGS, or fixed costs. It just tells me the drop is big and fast enough that I'd expect one or two large drivers, not a dozen small ones.

Interviewer · 1:45

Understood. Let's move to numbers. Which of your branches would you pull data on first, and why?

Candidate · 2:06

Fair enough. Here's how I'd structure the investigation. Since margin is profit over revenue, and revenue is actually growing, the margin drop has to be a cost problem — costs are rising faster than revenue. So I'd frame the whole case around isolating where those costs are coming from. I'd break it into three buckets. First, cost of goods sold — that's coffee beans, milk, cups, food. Have input prices spiked? Coffee bean prices have been volatile, so that's a real candidate. Second, operating costs — labor, rent, utilities. Wages have risen a lot recently, and if we're opening new stores, we may be carrying rent and staffing on locations that aren't profitable yet. Third, the growth itself. That 15% revenue growth isn't free. If we grew by opening new stores or discounting heavily to drive traffic, we could be buying revenue at a loss. New stores especially can drag margins for the first year or two while they ramp up. So my plan would be to size each of these buckets — figure out which one moved the most over the two years — and focus there. My instinct is the growth strategy and labor are the biggest suspects, but I'd want the numbers to confirm before committing. Where would you like me to start? Is that framework MECE? What's not in it? Honest answer: it's not fully MECE. The overlap problem: my "growth" bucket isn't cleanly separate from the other two. If new stores drag margin, that shows up as labor and rent in bucket two — so I'd be double-counting the same costs under two headings. Growth is really a lens on the other buckets, not a parallel category. The gap: I framed this as purely a cost problem, but that's not airtight. Margin can also fall if revenue quality drops — for example, if that 15% growth came from discounting, the price per cup fell, so revenue grew on volume while margin per unit shrank. That's a pricing/revenue-mix issue, not a cost line. I glossed over it. A cleaner structure would be two mutually exclusive branches: revenue side (price per unit, product mix) and cost side (COGS, then operating costs, split into fixed and variable). Then treat new-store ramp as a cross-cutting factor I test against whichever line moved — not its own bucket. So — better MECE version: are we earning less per unit, or spending more per unit? Then decompose each. Okay. Go ahead. Good — let me revise it cleanly. The math anchor: margin fell means cost per dollar of revenue rose. So either we're earning less per unit sold, or spending more per unit. Two mutually exclusive branches. Revenue side — are we earning less per unit? I'd check whether average price per cup fell. That happens if we discounted to drive traffic, or if the product mix shifted toward cheaper items. This matters because 15% revenue growth on falling prices means we grew on pure volume, which quietly crushes margin. Cost side — are we spending more per unit? Two sub-branches: Variable costs (COGS): beans, milk, cups, food — do they scale with each cup sold. Coffee bean prices have been genuinely volatile the last couple years, so this is a live suspect. Fixed costs: rent, salaried labor, utilities — costs we pay regardless of volume. Then the cross-cutting test: new-store ramp. Rather than its own bucket, I'd overlay it on whichever line moved. If fixed costs jumped, I'd ask whether it's new stores carrying rent and staff before they've ramped. If price per unit dropped, I'd ask whether new stores are discounting to build a customer base. My working hypothesis — and I'd want data to confirm — is that the drop is too steep and too fast to be input costs alone. An 18-point margin swing in two years smells like either aggressive discounting or a wave of unprofitable new stores. I'd size those two first. Where do you want to point me? Walk me through that 18-point swing — how did you get there? It's just the two numbers you gave me: margin went from 24% to 6%. 24 minus 6 is 18 percentage points. One thing to flag, since precision matters here: that's an 18-point drop, but in relative terms it's a 75% collapse in margin — we kept only a quarter of the profitability we had. I'd use the relative framing when I talk to the CEO, because "we lost three-quarters of our margin" lands harder and is arguably the truer picture of the damage. And to be clear about what I don't know yet — that 18 points tells me the size of the problem, not the cause. It doesn't tell me whether it's price, COGS, or fixed costs. It just tells me the drop is big and fast enough that I'd expect one or two large drivers, not a dozen small ones. Understood. Let's move to numbers. Which of your branches would you pull data on first, and why? I'd pull the revenue side first — specifically average price per cup, or average transaction value, over the two years. Two reasons. First, it's the cheapest test with the highest information value. It's essentially one data point — revenue divided by units sold, tracked over time. If price per unit dropped, I've likely found a major driver and I know the growth was "bought." If it held flat or rose, I've cleanly eliminated the entire revenue branch and can pour everything into the cost side. Either result sharpens the whole case. Second, it disambiguates that 15% revenue growth, which right now is the most misleading number I have. Revenue growing while margin collapses is the central puzzle. Knowing whether that growth came from more units or higher prices tells me which branch the problem lives in before I spend effort decomposing costs. So: one query, and it either points me somewhere or rules out half the tree. To be honest about the tradeoff — if I had a strong prior that input costs were the culprit, say coffee prices spiked industry-wide, I might go to COGS first. But absent that signal, the revenue test is the higher-leverage opening move. What does the data show?

Interviewer · 2:08

\$6.80 (up from \$6.20 two years ago, +10%)

Candidate · 2:28

Interesting — that clears the revenue branch. Price per cup rose 10%, so we're earning more per unit, not less. No discounting story here. The revenue branch is eliminated. That actually sharpens the puzzle. Prices are up 10% and revenue is up 15%, which means unit volume grew only modestly — roughly 5%. So this isn't a "bought growth on volume" problem at all. We're charging more and margin still collapsed. That points hard at the cost side — costs per unit rose faster than the 10% price increase could cover. So I'd pivot entirely to costs, and I'd go to COGS next — beans, milk, cups. If input prices ran up more than 10%, that alone could explain a chunk of it. And it flags something worth naming for the CEO: we already passed a 10% price increase to customers and it wasn't enough, which limits how much more we can lean on pricing to fix this. Can I see COGS per unit, or cost of goods as a percentage of revenue, over the two years?

Interviewer · 2:31

58% of revenue (up from 42% two years ago)

Candidate · 2:54

There it is. That's the core of the problem. COGS jumped from 42% to 58% of revenue — 16 points. Your total margin fell 18 points. So COGS alone explains almost the entire collapse. Everything else — rent, labor — is basically a rounding error by comparison. And here's the sharp part: this happened despite the 10% price increase. We raised prices and COGS as a share of revenue still blew up by 16 points. That means input costs didn't just rise — they rose dramatically faster than our already-higher prices. Napkin math: if COGS went from 42% to 58% of a per-unit price that itself rose 10%, cost per cup went up somewhere on the order of 50%. That's not normal inflation. That's a step-change in what it costs us to make a cup. So the case has narrowed to one question: why did per-unit input costs explode? I'd want to decompose COGS into its pieces — beans, milk, cups/package, food — to see if it's one runaway line or broad. My prior leans toward coffee beans, since green coffee prices have genuinely spiked in this period, but I'd confirm rather than assume. A few candidate explanations to test: Input price spike we failed to hedge or pass through — beans especially. Waste or spoilage — are new stores over-ordering and throwing product out. Mix shift toward COGS-heavy items — more food, more milk-heavy drinks. A procurement or supplier change — did we lose volume discounts or switch vendors. Can I get the COGS breakdown by component, two years ago versus now?

Interviewer · 2:56

I don't have that level of component detail yet. But I can tell you coffee bean prices have moved — let me show you that data. +40% increase in raw coffee bean costs

Candidate · 3:26

Okay, but let me push back on my own instinct here, because I think the beans are a trap if I stop there. A 40% jump in bean costs is real and it matters — but it can't be the whole story, and I want to be careful not to let it be. Beans are only one input, and they're typically a fairly small slice of a coffee shop's COGS — often something like 10–15% of it, with milk, cups, food, and packaging making up the rest. So a 40% rise on a 10–15% slice moves total COGS by maybe 4–6 points, not 16. I'm working from industry rule-of-thumb here, not your data, so flag that as a moderate-confidence estimate — but the shape of the argument holds: beans alone don't get us to a 16-point swing. So the beans explain part of it, and they're a clean, defensible chunk of the story. But there's a gap of roughly 10-plus points of COGS increase that beans don't cover. Something else moved too. That's why I still want the component breakdown. The candidates for that remaining gap: Milk and dairy, which also spiked in this period and are usually a bigger COGS line than beans. Waste and spoilage — especially if new stores are over-ordering. Mix shift toward milk- and food-heavy drinks, which carry more COGS per dollar. Portion or recipe drift, or loss of a volume discount from procurement. So the honest read: beans are a confirmed contributor but only a partial one. I'd resist walking into the CEO's office and saying "it's coffee prices" — that's the easy answer, it's incomplete, and it points at something we can't control instead of the levers we can. Can we get COGS split by component, even rough? That's the one piece that would let me size the gap.

Interviewer · 3:28

Candidate · 3:52

The table confirms it cleanly. Let me read it back. COGS: 42 ' 50 ' 58, climbing 8 points a year, 16 total. Labor: flat at 22 the whole time. Overhead: 12 ' 13 ' 14, drifting up 2 points total — minor. Profit: 24 ' 15 ' 6, tracking almost perfectly as the mirror image of COGS. So this is now unambiguous: COGS is the entire story. 16 of the 18 points come from COGS; overhead is a distant, marginal contributor; labor is a non-factor. That also kills a couple of my earlier hypotheses — no runaway labor from new-store staffing, no rent blowout. Good, I can drop those. Two things worth naming. First, the trend is linear and steady — 8 points per year, two years running. That's not a one-time shock. A single bad bean contract or a one-off price spike would more likely show up as a jump then a plateau. A steady 8-points-a-year climb suggests something ongoing and compounding — sustained input inflation, or a cost we're absorbing rather than passing through, getting worse each year. Second — this reframes the beans. Earlier I argued beans alone couldn't explain 16 points, and I'll stand by that. But I no longer have a competing cost line to blame, because labor and overhead are basically flat. So the remaining ~10 points of COGS increase is inside COGS — other inputs (milk especially), waste, or mix shift — not somewhere else in the P&L. To confirm my confidence levels: high confidence it's a COGS problem; moderate confidence beans are only a partial driver; still unverified what makes up the rest. The one piece I still need is the COGS component split. Without it I

can size the problem but can't finish the "why." Is that genuinely unavailable, or should I proceed by reasoning about the most likely composition?

Interviewer · 3:54

You'd have to reason about it. But take a step back — you've isolated the driver. What's your recommendation to the CEO?

Candidate · 4:20

Here's the recommendation. The headline: this is a cost problem, specifically input costs, and it's fixable — but not primarily through more price increases, since we already raised prices 10% and it wasn't enough. I'd frame three moves, in order of leverage: First, procurement. This is the biggest lever. COGS climbed 8 points a year, steadily — that pattern says we're absorbing input inflation rather than managing it. I'd attack it with supplier renegotiation, volume commitments across our 200 stores to win discounts, and hedging or forward contracts on beans and dairy so we're not exposed to spot-price swings. At our scale we have buying power we're likely underusing. Second, waste and operational discipline. I'm flagging this as a hypothesis, not a confirmed finding — I don't have the component data. But steady COGS creep is often partly spoilage, over-portioning, or recipe drift. It's worth an audit because it's fast and cheap to fix if it's there. Third, targeted pricing and mix — carefully. Not across-the-board hikes, since we've tested customer tolerance already. More like nudging the menu toward higher-margin items and trimming the drinks that are COGS-heavy. The honest caveat: I can size the problem — 16 of 18 points is COGS — but I can't yet tell you how much of it is beans versus milk versus waste. That component split is the one piece of data that would let us aim precisely instead of pulling all three levers at once. So my actual recommendation is a two-track answer: start the procurement renegotiation now because it's high-leverage regardless of the mix, and in parallel pull the COGS breakdown so we're not guessing on the rest. One thing I'd resist telling the CEO: "it's just coffee prices." It's the tempting answer, it's partly true, and it points entirely at something outside our control — which is exactly why I don't trust it as the whole story.

Interviewer · 4:21